

Travel Safety Guide

Purpose

This guide provides essential travel safety information for road trips within India. It includes general road safety practices, emergency preparedness, personal safety recommendations, weather precautions, and emergency contact information for travelers using cars, motorcycles, or bicycles.

1. General Road Safety

Road safety should always be the highest priority during any journey. Before beginning a trip, ensure both the traveler and the vehicle are fully prepared.

Safety Checklist

- Wear appropriate safety gear.
- Carry a valid driving license.
- Keep vehicle registration and insurance documents.
- Check weather conditions before departure.
- Inform a trusted person about your travel route.
- Keep a fully charged mobile phone.
- Carry a power bank.
- Avoid driving while tired.

2. Motorcycle Safety

Motorcycle travel requires additional precautions due to increased exposure to weather and road hazards.

Essential Riding Gear

- ISI-certified helmet
- Riding jacket
- Riding gloves
- Riding boots
- Knee guards
- Reflective vest (recommended)
- Rain gear during monsoon

Safe Riding Practices

- Maintain safe following distance.
- Avoid sudden braking.
- Keep headlights on during low visibility.

- Reduce speed during rain.
- Never use mobile phones while riding.

3. Car Travel Safety

Before every road trip, inspect the vehicle thoroughly.

Vehicle Inspection

- Engine oil
- Coolant level
- Tire pressure
- Spare tire
- Brakes
- Battery
- Headlights
- Indicators
- Windshield wipers

Driving Recommendations

- Wear seat belts at all times.
- Obey speed limits.
- Avoid aggressive driving.
- Do not drive while distracted.
- Share driving responsibilities on long trips.

4. Bicycle Travel Safety

Cyclists should maximize visibility and plan routes carefully.

Recommended Equipment

- Helmet
- Reflective clothing
- Front light
- Rear light
- Bell
- Repair kit
- Water bottle

Cycling Safety

- Ride on the left side of the road.
- Use hand signals while turning.
- Stay visible at intersections.

- Avoid cycling after dark whenever possible.

5. Emergency Essentials

Every traveler should carry a basic emergency kit.

First Aid Kit

- Bandages
- Antiseptic solution
- Cotton
- Pain relief medicine
- Fever medicine
- Allergy medication
- ORS packets
- Tweezers
- Medical tape

Additional Emergency Items

- Flashlight
- Multi-tool
- Power bank
- Emergency blanket
- Drinking water
- Energy bars
- Rain poncho

6. Weather Safety

Summer

Risks

- Heat stroke
- Dehydration
- Tire overheating

Recommendations

- Drink water frequently.
- Wear light-colored clothing.
- Avoid afternoon travel when possible.
- Check coolant levels.

Monsoon

Risks

- Slippery roads
- Waterlogging
- Poor visibility

Recommendations

- Reduce speed.
- Increase braking distance.
- Wear waterproof gear.
- Avoid flooded roads.

Winter

Risks

- Fog
- Low visibility
- Cold exposure

Recommendations

- Use fog lights.
- Wear warm clothing.
- Start travel after sunrise when possible.
- Carry extra blankets.

7. Mountain Road Safety

Mountain roads require additional caution.

Best Practices

- Drive slowly.
- Use lower gears on descents.
- Avoid overtaking on blind curves.
- Honk before sharp bends.
- Check brakes frequently.
- Carry sufficient fuel.

8. Solo Travel Safety

Solo travelers should remain connected and cautious.

Recommendations

- Share live location with trusted contacts.
- Avoid isolated areas after dark.
- Book verified accommodations.
- Carry emergency cash.
- Keep copies of important documents.

9. Emergency Contacts (India)

Service	Number
National Emergency	112
Ambulance	108
Police	100
Fire	101
Women Helpline	1091
National Highway Helpline	1033

10. Safety Do's

- Wear helmets and seat belts.
- Follow traffic rules.
- Keep emergency contacts handy.
- Stay hydrated.
- Take breaks every 2–3 hours.
- Check weather before traveling.
- Keep vehicle documents accessible.

11. Safety Don'ts

- Do not drink and drive.
- Do not overspeed.
- Do not use mobile phones while driving.
- Do not ignore weather warnings.
- Do not travel with faulty brakes or tires.
- Do not ride without protective gear.
- Do not continue driving when fatigued.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How often should I take breaks during a road trip?

Take a 15–20 minute break every 2–3 hours of continuous driving or riding.

Q: Is carrying a first aid kit recommended?

Yes. Every road trip should include a basic first aid kit.

Q: What should I do if my vehicle breaks down?

Move the vehicle to a safe location, switch on hazard lights, contact roadside assistance if available, and avoid standing in moving traffic.

Q: Is it safe to drive during heavy rain?

Only if visibility remains adequate. Reduce speed significantly and avoid flooded roads.

Q: What documents should I always carry?

- Driving License
- Vehicle Registration Certificate (RC)
- Insurance Certificate
- Pollution Under Control (PUC) Certificate (where applicable)
- Government-issued Photo ID

13. Quick Safety Summary

Before every trip, remember the **SAFE** checklist:

- **S** – Safety gear and vehicle inspection
- **A** – Adequate fuel, food, and water
- **F** – First aid kit and fully charged phone
- **E** – Emergency contacts and weather check